

Forcing Firefox to Execute XSS Payloads during 302 Redirects

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Content

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Forcing Firefox to Execute XSS Payloads during 302 Redirects

Initial Discovery

During a recent engagement I identified an open redirect where a GET parameter would be reflected as-is in the HTTP response Location header without any kind of sanitization. Something similar to this:

[image: open_redirect]

Trying multiple kinds of injections, I discovered that newlines and carriage returns characters could be inserted, leading to header injection:

[image: header_injection]

Even more interesting, we can inject arbitrary content in the HTTP response body by inserting two newline characters, leading to reflected cross-site scripting:

[image: body_inject]

However, modern browsers (Google Chrome, Internet Explorer, Firefox) do not interpret the HTTP response body if the HTTP response status code is a 302, so our cross-site scripting payload is useless. Time to find a bypass !

Prior Work

By searching for prior bypasses, I stumbled upon this [blog post](#) where Fortinet describes how they bypassed the execution block by setting the Location header to a URI starting with 'mailto://'. [Bugcrowd forums](#) also provides some insight into bypasses that may have worked in the past. And this excellent [HackerOne report](#) on XSS affecting Twitter, where they used a Location header starting with '//x:1/' definitely sent me in the right direction.

Let's Fuzz

Given that none of the already documented bypasses worked, I decided to write a dumb fuzzer that would generate a list of URLs and open them with xdg-open. To do so, I downloaded the [IANA URI schemes list](#) and generated a list of URLs following this format: [http://acme.corp/?redir=\[URI_SCHEME\]://gremwell.com%0A%0A\[XSS_PAYLOAD\]](http://acme.corp/?redir=[URI_SCHEME]://gremwell.com%0A%0A[XSS_PAYLOAD]). Google Chrome and Firefox were tested in this way, Internet Explorer was also tested but with a PowerShell script rather than simply calling xdg-open. I then spent quite some time closing browser tabs, hoping to be greeted with an alert box :)

A Valid Candidate

Two candidates out of the full IANA URI scheme list worked, and only on Firefox:

- ws:// (WebSocket)
- wss:// (Secure WebSocket).

It simply looks like this:

[\[image: valid_bypass\]](#)

Opening the link in the latest version of Firefox (version 81 at the time of writing) and we see we are executing JavaScript under the right domain, without being redirected:

[\[image: xss_trigger\]](#)

Proof-of-Concept

If you want to test this at home, you can download the [302_server](#) script. It will launch a Python3 HTTP server on port 8000, mimicking the behavior I just described.

Update - October 1st 2020

[Sergey Bobrov](#) just [pointed out](#) that using an empty Location header will work to force Google Chrome to execute the payload. Nice find !

Update - October 2nd 2020

[Maxim Rupp](#) just [pointed out](#) that using an resource:// URI in the Location header will work to force Firefox 81 to execute the payload. Nice find !

Contacts

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